

**LIVE**

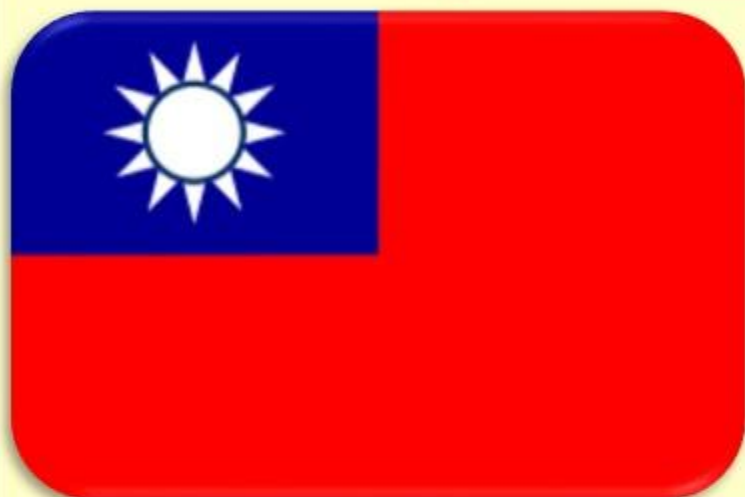


**NEWSPAPER**

**7<sup>th</sup> DEC, 2018**

**ITEM WISE EDITORIALS**

**49<sup>th</sup> WEEK**



# CHINA-TAIWAN RELATIONS & DONALD TRUMP

**UPSC CSE – GS II**

**GS II ... International Relations**



Learning Space

**LIVE**



# NEWSPAPER EDITORIALS

... DISCUSSION

**7<sup>th</sup> DECEMBER, 2018**



## 4

### The Taiwan card

Taipei's fine balance in its relationship with mainland China is coming under stress

The huge gains for the opposition Kuomintang, or the Chinese Nationalist Party, in Taiwan's local elections may help in gradually improving the island's ties with mainland China. Equally, the adverse results in some of its strongholds could complicate matters for the ruling Democratic Progressive Party government ahead of the 2020 general elections. President Tsai Ing-wen has stepped down as the party chief, owing moral responsibility for the setback; her re-election bid is in doubt. The pro-independence stance of the DPP is at variance with Beijing's repeated assertion of its sovereignty over Taiwan, which it insists it is prepared to defend through the use of force. All the same, the Taiwanese government has been equally concerned to not allow the long-standing dispute to escalate to a point of jeopardising the strong trade relations between the two territories. But this delicate balance has turned somewhat more precarious since Donald Trump became President of the United States. Ever since his election, he has sought to leverage Taiwan to pressure China in the U.S.'s ongoing trade war. A first indication was the congratulatory call he received from Ms. Tsai on his poll victory. The episode raised concerns over the status of U.S.-China diplomatic relations, established in 1979, and the consequent downgrading of the U.S.'s ties with Taipei to unofficial exchanges. The 2018 Taiwan Travel Act aims to promote greater engagement between Washington and Taipei. Similarly, the new headquarters of the American Institute in Taiwan in Taipei is symbolic of the shift. The Taiwanese President's recent visits to the U.S. and interactions with several Congressmen have predictably angered Beijing.

Meanwhile, frictions between the two neighbours have also increased. Taipei has alleged that the recent mayoral elections were marred by Beijing's meddling, with money funnelled illegally to fund opposition campaigns. Business corporations have come under pressure to take down references to Taiwan as a separate entity. Beijing is believed to be applying overt and covert pressure to stop countries from according diplomatic recognition to Taipei. In an echo of China's increasing economic clout among developing countries, a number of African and Central American states have withdrawn formal ties with Taipei and established links with Beijing since Ms. Tsai became President. In a referendum coinciding with the polls, the people rejected a proposal to rename the country's Olympic team as Taiwan, in stead of the current Chinese Taipei. The verdict is an indication of the limited support for independence and a greater preference to maintain the status quo. Taiwan stands to gain by staying clear of big power rivalries.

## UPSC CSE – GS II

### GS II ... International Relations

Effect of policies and politics of developed and developing countries on India's interests, Indian diaspora.

## 4 The Taiwan card

Taipei's fine balance in its relationship with mainland China is coming under stress. The huge gains for the opposition Kuomintang, or the Chinese Nationalist Party, in Taiwan's local elections may help in gradually improving the island's ties with mainland China. Equally, the adverse results in some of its strongholds could complicate matters for the ruling Democratic Progressive Party government ahead of the 2020 general elections. President Tsai Ing-wen has stepped down as the party chief, owning moral responsibility for the setback; her re-election bid is in doubt. The pro-independence stance of the DPP is at variance with Beijing's repeated assertion of its sovereignty over Taiwan, which it insists it is prepared to defend through the use of force. All the same, the Taiwanese government has been equally concerned to not allow the long-standing dispute to escalate to a point of jeopardising the strong trade relations between the two territories. But this delicate balance has turned somewhat more precarious since Donald Trump became President of the United States. Ever since his election, he has sought to leverage Taiwan to pressure China in the U.S.'s ongoing trade war. A first indication was the congratulatory call he received from Ms. Tsai on his poll victory. The episode raised concerns over the status of U.S.-China diplomatic relations, established in 1979, and the consequent downgrading of the U.S.'s ties with Taipei to unofficial exchanges. The 2018 Taiwan Travel Act aims to promote greater engagement between Washington and Taipei. Similarly, the new headquarters of the American Institute in Taiwan in Taipei is symbolic of the shift. The Taiwanese President's recent visits to the U.S. and interactions with several Congressmen have predictably angered Beijing.



## 4 The Taiwan card

Meanwhile, frictions between the two neighbours have also increased. Taipei has alleged that the recent mayoral elections were marred by Beijing's meddling, with money funnelled illegally to fund opposition campaigns. Business corporations have come under pressure to take down references to Taiwan as a separate entity. Beijing is believed to be applying overt and covert pressure to stop countries from according diplomatic recognition to Taipei. In an echo of China's increasing economic clout among developing countries, a number of African and Central American states have withdrawn formal ties with Taipei and established links with Beijing since Ms. Tsai became President. In a referendum coinciding with the polls, the people rejected a proposal to rename the country's Olympic team as Taiwan, instead of the current Chinese Taipei. The verdict is an indication of the limited support for independence and a greater preference to maintain the status quo. Taiwan stands to gain by staying clear of big power rivalries.

## TAIWAN ... FACTS AND FIGURES



- It is an island nation.
- Practically independent since 1950.
- Area ... 36,188 sq.km
- Population ... 23.6 million
- Capital ... Taipei
- Major religions ... Taoism, Buddhism, Christianity

- Currency ... New Taiwan Dollar
- Official Name ... Republic of China
- Nominal GDP ... \$ 500 billion
- Formal diplomatic relations with only a few countries
- One of the world's top producers of computer technology
- Major languages ... Mandarin Chinese, Min Nan Chinese





- The ruling Democratic Progressive Party lost some of the strongholds.
- General elections are going to be held in 2020.



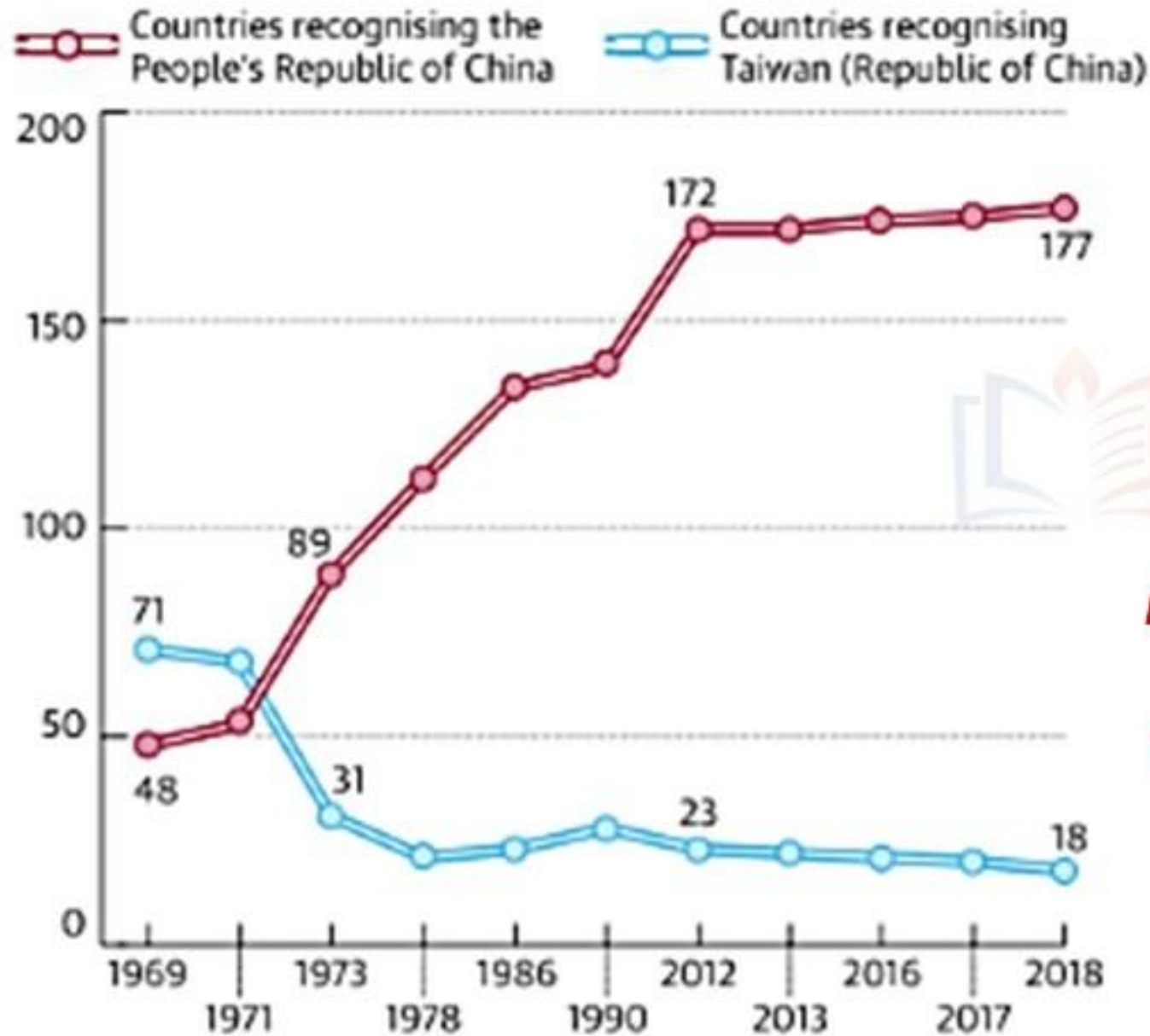


## A BRIEF INTO TAIWAN-CHINA DISPUTE

- After the surrender of Japan during World War II, the island of Taiwan was kept under Chinese control.
- During the end of Civil War in 1949, members of KMT were driven out of the mainland by the Communists.
- The Communists established the People's Republic of China.
- KMT retreated to Taiwan and established Government in exile. For some time, it was internationally recognized as the Government of the Republic of China.
- The Turf War over the name began in 1970s.

*In recent decades, under Chinese pressure, both IMF and World Bank have been using the name, the Chinese Taipei.*





***Beijing benefited from this policy as Taiwan was kept out of diplomatic relations officially. Taiwan is not recognized as an independent country by much of the World and even the United Nations did not recognize this.***

## RELATIONSHIP BETWEEN CHINA AND TAIWAN



**TSAI ING - WEN**  
President, Taiwan



- 1** China repeatedly asserts its sovereignty over Taiwan. Sometimes it says, it is prepared to do it through the use of force.
- 2** Taiwan on the other hand, is also equally concerned to not allow the long standing dispute to escalate up to the point of affecting the strong trade relations.
- 3** This delicate balance has turned somewhat more precarious since Mr. Donald Trump became the President of USA. He sought to leverage Taiwan to pressurize China in the U.S.' ongoing trade war.



## HOW CHINA IS EXERTING PRESSURE ON TAIWAN?



- 1 Taipei has alleged that China intervened in the recent mayoral elections.
- 2 Business corporations are under pressure to take down references to Taiwan as a separate entity.
- 3 China is applying overt and covert pressure to stop countries from according diplomatic recognition to Taipei.
- 4 Number of African and Central American countries have withdrawn formal ties with Taipei, since Ms. Tsai became the President.
- 5 Recently, in a referendum, the people rejected a proposal to rename the Country's Olympic Team as "Taiwan", instead of the current "Chinese Taipei". The verdict is an indication of the limited support for independence and a greater preference to maintain the status quo.

WE EXPRESS OUR  
SINCERE THANKS  
FOR VIEWING THIS VIDEO

Presented by



Learning Space

For Suggestions:

[suggestions@learningspace.in](mailto:suggestions@learningspace.in)

To Contact us:

[info@learningspace.in](mailto:info@learningspace.in)

**OUR TEAM**

G. V. Rao

K. Srikanth

D. Sunil Kumar

L. V. Krishna

Y. Deepthi

Amrita Naidu

M. Binukrishna

G. Ravi Babu

D. Joji

K. Victor Babu

Visit us at:

[www.learningspacedigital.com](http://www.learningspacedigital.com)

0 8 6 6 -2 4 4 4 4 7 2

0 9 8 4 9 9 4 2 2 9 9